

EDU301

Glossary

❖ Active learning

Any of a wide range of teaching strategies that engage the learner in the instruction taking place, such as working on problems in small groups, as opposed to passive methods such as seat work or listening to a lecture.

❖ Advance organizer

A frame of reference for a lesson, such as a chart, study guide, list, or graph, that presents the main facts, concepts, or generalizations to be learned.

❖ Affective domain

The area of learning that encompasses ethical, emotional, attitudinal, and social knowledge.

❖ Analysis

The process of discovering relationships, interactions, and causality among ideas, concepts, and situations.

❖ Assessment

The process of evaluating student performance using a variety of measurements, such as tests, observations, ratings, and portfolios.

❖ Awareness

The ability of a teacher to recognize student needs and demands and adjust the classroom environment to meet them.

❖ **Behavior modification**

The process of changing behavior by rewarding desired actions and ignoring or punishing undesired actions.

❖ **Behavioral perspective**

An educational approach that stresses changing student actions by rewarding and reinforcing desired actions and outcomes.

❖ **Bloom's taxonomy**

A classification system for cognitive educational objectives.

❖ **Brainstorming**

A discussion process in which the leader presents a topic or problem and solicits open-ended ideas about it from all group members.

❖ **Character development**

An aspect of schooling that includes discussion of ethical issues and moral dilemmas, with the goal of developing characteristics such as trustworthiness, respect, responsibility, and citizenship.

❖ **Checklist**

List-format assessment tools used by a teacher or student to document work completed or skills learned.

❖ **Classroom management**

The methods of organization, disciplinary procedures, and routines established by the teacher to ensure positive student behaviors that are conducive to learning and social interaction.

❖ **Cognitive domain**

The area of learning encompassing intellectual aspects, such as information processing, memorization, and thinking skills.

❖ **Cognitive psychology**

An area of psychology that focus on inner mental processes rather than behavior.

❖ **Concept**

An expression or abstraction based on observations of a group of stimuli, facts, or objects having common characteristics; for example, the concept “animal” encompasses and describes dogs, cats, and elephants.

❖ **Concept analysis**

The process of identifying the components of a concept to be taught and deciding whether to teach it inductively (from underlying specific examples to broader generalizations) or deductively (from broader generalizations to underlying specific examples).

❖ **Concrete operational stage**

A stage of cognitive development (ages 8–11) in which children learn best through visual and hands-on activities.

❖ **Conditions**

The specification of what is needed to accomplish an objective.

❖ **Content**

The subject matter, substance, or materials of a lesson, consisting of facts, concepts, and generalizations.

❖ **Convergent questions**

Questions that require students to give factual or specific answers.

❖ **Cooperative learning**

Learning based on a small group approach to teaching, in which students are held accountable for both individual and group achievement.

❖ **Correlation**

A relationship between two factors, but not necessarily one of cause and effect.

❖ **Criteria**

Characteristics used to categorize or rate ideas or products.

❖ **Criterion measure**

The third element of a performance objective, which defines the minimum level of acceptable performance.

❖ **Curriculum alignment**

The process of making certain that the curriculum is organized and coordinated with what is tested.

❖ **Declarative knowledge**

Knowledge of content (what), such as facts, definitions, and concepts, as opposed to knowledge of processes (how). Also called content knowledge.

❖ **Deductive reasoning**

The process of discovering specific examples or facts from a generalizing framework; a thinking process that moves from the general to the specific.

❖ **Definition**

The presenting of what something means.

❖ **Direct instruction**

Teacher-initiated whole-class learning.

❖ **Discipline**

The setting of behavioral parameters for the classroom, both by the teacher alone and in response to teacher-student interactions and situational factors.

❖ **Discovery learning**

An inquiry process in which learners pose questions and seek explanations.

❖ **Discussions**

Interactive learning processes involving the exchange of information, perceptions, and ideas in a small group.

❖ **Distractors**

The incorrect alternative answers on a multiple-choice test.

❖ **Divergent questions**

Questions that encourage students to give complex, creative, longer answers. eclectic Made up of a mix of varied approaches or teaching models.

❖ **Efficacy**

Effectiveness; the ability to reach a goal or complete a task.

❖ **Enabling skills**

Facts, concepts, and processes students must be taught before they can learn more complex facts, concepts, and processes.

❖ **Equity**

A moral rationale that all children should be given the same opportunities to succeed in school.

❖ **Evaluation**

The process of making judgments and supporting one's viewpoints with specific criteria, facts, and values. In education, determining the effectiveness of a lesson or unit in terms of student outcomes.

❖ **Example**

A concrete or specific form of a more abstract concept.

❖ **Exceptionality**

A condition in which a student qualifies for special services by virtue of his or her physical, cognitive, or emotional characteristics and abilities.

❖ **Experience**

The totality of the events and activities in which a student has participated as part of planned learning processes.

❖ **Facilitator**

The supportive role a teacher takes by giving students the skills, materials, and opportunities they need to direct their own learning experiences.

❖ **Fact**

The most fundamental piece of information, which is singular in occurrence, occurs or exists in the present time, does not help the learner predict other facts, and is acquired solely through the process of observation.

❖ **Feedback**

Information that students can use to improve their performance.

❖ **Formal operations stage**

A stage of cognitive development (ages 11–15 and above) in which adolescents develop knowledge through systematic reasoning.

❖ **Formative assessment**

A type of classroom assessment devoted entirely to the enhancement of student learning and achievement via specific feedback.

❖ **General instructional objectives**

Statements of what is to be learned that are broad and encompassing.

❖ **Generalization**

An inferential statement that expresses relationships between concepts and has predictive value.

❖ **Goals**

The broad, general outcomes students should reach as the result of a learning experience, lesson, or unit of study; for example, “Students will learn to appreciate and interpret drama.”

❖ **Graphic organizers**

Pictures, outlines, sketches, or some pictorial display that help the learner to obtain a quick mental perception or image of the topic.

❖ **Guided inductive inquiry**

A learning process in which the teacher provides specific facts or ideas, from which students make their own generalizations.

❖ **Higher-level thinking**

A multistage construction of meaning that employs analysis and synthesis. Also called critical thinking.

❖ **Holistic instructional view**

A model for instructional planning that considers many social and educational factors simultaneously.

❖ **Inclusion**

A commitment to provide maximum learning experiences for all students, including those with special cognitive, affective, or psychomotor needs, in regular classrooms.

❖ **Inclusive classroom**

A classroom in which any learner with a disability is educated alongside students without disabilities.

❖ **Independent skills**

Learning that can be taught without any prerequisite skills.

❖ **Individual Education Plan (IEP)**

An agreement between a student with special learning needs and his or her classroom teachers, special education staff, and parents that outlines educational goals, procedures, and expected outcomes.

❖ **Induction**

The process of analyzing specific ideas to form more general concepts.

❖ **Inductive inquiry**

The process of inferring generalizations from a set of specific ideas or facts

❖ **Inductive reasoning**

The process of studying examples or facts in order to develop generalizations or concepts; a thinking process that moves from the specific to the general

❖ **Information processing**

A means used to learn and remember knowledge.

❖ **Inquiry process**

An investigative learning process that includes skills such as classifying, predicting, and experimenting.

❖ **Inquiry teaching**

An investigative process of learning in which students are asked to pose questions, analyze data, and develop conclusions or generalizations.

❖ **Instructional model**

A detailed organizational scheme of how something is used.

❖ **Integration**

The third step in the advance organizer model, in which students see how main concepts and underlying facts are related (vertical integration) or how underlying facts are similar or different (horizontal integration).

❖ **Interdisciplinary thematic unit**

A unit of instruction that incorporates various content areas while covering an overall topic or theme, such as “Dinosaurs” or “Seeds.”

❖ **Interpersonal**

Occurring between people.

❖ **Intrapersonal**

Occurring within an individual.

❖ **Intrinsic motivation**

An incentive, such as pride, self-esteem, and the desire to learn, that comes from within the student.

❖ **Knowledge**

Recognition and recall of facts and explicitly stated concepts

❖ **Learning activities**

Hands-on, interactive classroom experiences.

❖ **Learning community**

The concept of a school as a social unit that supports all members—students, teachers, administrators, staff, and parents.

❖ **Learning style**

The set of cognitive, affective, and physiological traits that a learner exhibits as he or she interacts in the classroom environment and determines how he or she will solve problems. Also called learning preference.

❖ **Lesson**

A piece of a unit, in which a given set of objectives or concepts is taught.

❖ **Lesson plan**

The specification of what is to be done during class periods

❖ **Maslow's hierarchy of needs**

A theory that an individual's behavior at any time is determined by his or her needs, ranging from basic physiological needs such as hunger and thirst to the highest needs of self-actualization and transcendence.

❖ **Master teacher**

A teacher who possesses much experience and expertise and may serve as a role model or mentor for other teachers.

❖ **Measurement**

The process of assigning numerical achievement indicators to student performance.

❖ **Metacognition**

Conscious awareness of one's own thinking and learning process.

❖ **Metaphor**

A figure of speech describing something with implied terms.

❖ **Motivation**

The desire or incentive to learn something or to behave in a given way

❖ **Multi-methodology**

The teaching practice of using a wide variety of techniques during lessons so that every student will benefit from at least one mode of every presentation.

❖ **Multiple intelligences**

The concept that intelligence does not take just one form but exists in eight facets: verbal/linguistic, bodily/kinesthetic, intrapersonal, logical/mathematical, musical/rhythmic, visual/spatial, interpersonal, and naturalistic

❖ **Objectives**

The specific steps that must be achieved to realize a broader goal.

❖ **Outcome**

A description of some product or other tangible evidence that learning has occurred.

❖ **Performance objective**

A specific, observable outcome students should reach as the result of a learning experience or lesson; for example, "After reading the play, students will write an essay naming and describing five characters." Also called performance statement.

❖ **Physical diversity**

The variety of individuals' physical traits, such as height, weight, appearance, and physical ability.

❖ **Planning**

The process of choosing instructional goals, content, materials, and activities prior to teaching.

❖ **Preoperational stage**

An early stage of cognitive development (ages 2–8) in which children learn through intuition, experience, and concepts.

❖ **Prerequisite skills**

The skills or knowledge students must have before they begin a new learning experience.

❖ **Problem-based learning**

Technique in which questions are posed for students to solve.

❖ **Procedural knowledge**

Knowledge of processes (how), as opposed to knowledge of content (what). Also called process knowledge.

❖ **Programmed instruction**

A teaching method in which skills are presented in small segments, with immediate feedback and continual practice.

❖ **Psychomotor domain**

The area of learning encompassing physical movement, including gross and fine motor skills and coordination.

❖ **Reinforcement**

A system of rewards that encourages students to repeat positive behaviors.

❖ **Reinforcer**

A type of stimulus that has a good chance of increasing a desired behavior.

❖ **Rubrics**

Examples of different types, models, illustrations, or levels of possible responses that are used as guidelines for assessing student work.

❖ **School culture**

The environment of a school, including its values, management systems, communication styles, and interpersonal relationships.

❖ **Sensorimotor stage**

A period of cognitive development (ages 0–2) during which children learn through sensations and movement.

❖ **Sequencing**

The process of organizing instruction by placing curricula or learning tasks in order.

❖ **Simulation**

An artificial setting or situation that parallels a real-world setting or situation and allows students to practice problem-solving skills.

❖ **Small-group discussions**

Verbal exchanges of ideas and information in groups of four to eight students

❖ **Social capital**

The sum of interpersonal relationships that provide support or encouragement.

❖ **Strategic learning**

Student development of critical thinking skills that accelerate learning.

❖ **Synthesis**

A process of creatively combining facts, concepts, and learning processes into new knowledge.

❖ **Task Analysis Model**

The process of subdividing the content, concepts, or processes of a lesson into smaller, sequential steps that begin with the least complex and progress to the most complex.

❖ **Taxonomy**

A set of standards for classifying ideas or objects into hierarchical categories; for example, Bloom's taxonomy of cognitive skills.

❖ **Test**

An assessment instrument that requires students to answer questions to demonstrate learning.

❖ **Thinking**

A complex act comprising attitudes, knowledge, and skills that allows the individual to shape his or her environment more effectively than by intuition alone.

❖ **Unguided inductive inquiry**

A learning process in which students discover specific facts or ideas by themselves and then make their own generalizations based on what they have learned.

❖ **Unit**

A block of lessons grouped together based on related skills, concepts, or themes.

❖ **Unit plan**

A detailed plan for providing instruction on a skill, concept, or theme.

❖ **Zone of Proximal Development**

The difference between the intellectual level a child can reach on his or her own and the level that can be reached with expert assistance.

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